

Luca Alioto

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EDUCATION

Master of Urban and Regional Planning

University of California, Los Angeles • June 2028

Bachelor of Arts Political Science & Bachelor of Science Community Development

University of California, Davis • June 2026 • 3.8

Study Abroad: Housing & Urbanism in Barcelona

SKILLS

Quantitative Methods: Statistical Modeling, Causal Inference, Computational Text Analysis, Geospatial Analysis, Survey Design, Machine Learning
R, ArcGIS, JavaScript, Python, SQL, MATLAB, LaTeX, Quarto Git

Spanish Speaker - California Seal of Biliteracy and Upper Division Coursework

EXPERIENCE

Researcher - Dr. Jamey Volker

Institute of Transportation Studies, Davis

June 2024– PRESENT

- Conducted empirical analysis on housing and transportation policy using R, Python, and ArcGIS for statistical and spatial modeling.
- Assembled and linked parcel-level, census, and food accessibility datasets to evaluate ~2,000 ADUs across the Sacramento region using geospatial and regression techniques.
- Designed and administered a survey to 335 permit recipients, using findings to analyze data that generated policy-relevant insights.
- Authored a manuscript through the *Journal of the American Planning Association* and presented research findings at the Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (2025) Conference.

Policy Fellow and Leadership

Underground Scholars

September 2022 – PRESENT

- Collaborated with doctoral researchers to analyze effects of the carceral system and increase access to higher education for impacted communities.
- Secured \$5,000 in grants and coordinated multi-stakeholder events with UC Davis Law, the Aoki Center, and Yolo County Public Defenders to disseminate research and policy findings.
- Authored Associated Students UCD resolution directed to the UC Office of the President, Regents, and Administration.
- Facilitated meetings between students and university leadership to integrate student feedback into institutional planning and budget management for a new campus center now serving 100+ students.

Legislative Director - Campaign Coordinator

University of California, Student Association

September 2022 – 2025

- Conduct policy analysis and stakeholder outreach to advance the *Opportunity4All* campaign.
- Led advocacy training and workshops for 30+ students, strengthening skills in public speaking and policy communication.
- Organized lobbying visits of ~50 students in Sacramento & DC.
- Developed and evaluated legislative proposals on environmental justice, housing, and land use in collaboration with Dr. Catherine Brinkley and local policymakers.

Volunteer Preparer and Translator

NorCal Resist, Sacramento

September 2022 – Present

- Provided bilingual (Spanish-English) assistance to asylum seekers in completing Form I-589, Application for Asylum and Withholding of Removal.
- Collaborated with supervising attorneys to review case materials and support accurate application submissions.

PROJECTS

Honors Thesis - Advisor Dr. Juan Telles

Political Science Department • September 2025 - Present

- Writing an empirical thesis on political violence and democratic backsliding in El Salvador with a potential for further publication.
- Developing a research design and theoretical framework, conducting literature reviews, and applying quantitative methods to analyze institutional and social dynamics.

Research Assistant - Dr. Hanno Hilbig

Political Science Department • October 2024 - Present

- Conduct literature reviews and assist in theory development for projects on political behavior.
- Clean and analyze survey data in R, applying OLS regression and machine learning techniques